



One for the album: Welcoming Vijay Amritraj, Leander Paes and veteran tennis journalist Richard Evans, a chronicler of 200 Majors and the biographer of Amritraj, to the illustrious club were many of the game's greatest and fellow Hall of Famers. PICTURE COURTESY: ITHF

Tennis stars Leander, Amritraj make it India's day in Newport

Leander Paes and Vijay Amritraj were inducted into the International **Tennis Hall of Fame** in Newport, Rhode Island in July.

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The three-and-a-half-hour Amtrak ride on the NorthEast Regional Rail Network from Moynihan Train Hall in midtown Manhattan brings you to Kingston Station, which looks like a setting from an old Western (though this is the US East Coast) with its wood-panelled salon. But there's no

gun-toting cowboy in leather overalls waiting outside. Instead, you'll find an empty driveway, devoid of cars, people, or horses. It's as if the movie ended long ago; the actors and extras have all gone home, leaving the set behind.

With the nearest Uber ride 17 minutes away, you, with chirping crickets for company, pray it's not

another driver (like in India) who cancels after quizzing you about the fare. But, mercifully, Ruben — in his red Honda, not a red mare — arrives in half the time. The ride to Newport, crossing bridges over the Atlantic Ocean that stretch longer than the Mumbai Sealink, is pleasant and chatty as Ruben worries about the future of the New England Patriots